



Why would you want an SSD? For one thing, the response time will improve dramatically, especially if you dedicate your SSD as an OS drive (i.e. the drive on which you've installed your primary OS). An SSD has a response time that is at least 15-20 times greater than that of your HDD and the difference in startup times and responsiveness of programs installed on the SSD will be noticeable.

If you're a laptop user, you should also see a definite improvement to your battery life and as a bonus, you can rest assured that your data is more secure because an SSD is not as fragile as a HDD. The improvement to transfer rates is also an added bonus.

Heating issues

Laptops and Desktops tend to overheat if you've not bothered to take care of your airflow or your heatsinks are covered in

dust and gunk. Here's what you can do to fix that.

Get a new CPU cooler for your PC. A decent one will set you back by about ₹2,000, but you should see a dramatic reduction in operating temperature, sometimes by as much as 40 degrees. Your PC will operate cooler and faster for longer, and also help the longevity (in the long run).

Simple 120mm fans don't cost anything. Buy a handful from your local hardware store and intelligently place



them in your PC to improve airflow. Remember, the placement of the fans is very important and you have to plan with airflow in mind.

For laptops, the best thing to do is to get yourself a decent laptop cooler. It will add some bulk to your bag, but the improvements in cooling should directly translate to better performance and less stress on the components.

REVELING IN THE PAST

It's a little rarer now, but there are sure to be a great many of you who've still got an ageing collection of precious VHS tapes and LP records. It's high-time that you moved into the digital world, if only for archiving all that precious data.

You could take the easier, but more expensive route of paying for a professional service that will digitize and archive that collection for you.

Or, you could do it yourself.

You will, of course, need a large enough HDD to store all that data and a PC. You can then purchase a cheap, USB capture device that will accept the RCA, S-Video and any other vintage input that your player might use and directly stream that data to your PC for easy recording and capture. This works for cassette tapes too.



DEALS UNDER ₹200

LED Lamp (₹185): You can get USB LED lamps for as little as ₹99 and they're an excellent little tool with a great many applications. You can use them to light up your keyboard be it on a desktop or a laptop, use it as an emergency lamp and more. <http://dgit.in/1HCfPzV>

4-Port USB Hub (₹179): This is a brilliant little device to have. A 4-port USB hub with switches to control each individual port. It's a nice accessory to have in your back-pack. <http://dgit.in/1QsPdJ1>

GIVE THE LITTLE ONES A CHANCE

Get yourself a Raspberry Pi or an Arduino; these are in effect, tiny little computers that'll set you back by about ₹3,000, but can be a one-stop-shop for quite a lot of issues you never knew of.



- **Torrent box:** Torrenting is second nature to us and almost all our bandwidth requirements are defined by this need. Load up a Linux OS of

your choice, install a torrent client like Transmission and configure the Pi and/or transmission for remote access and you've got a tiny little device that only sips electricity and works as a torrent box!

- **Media Centre:** A Raspberry Pi in particular can make for a great media centre or media server. Coupled with automated torrenting, it's possible to setup a Pi to stream your media to your TV or any other device you choose.
- **Misc:** Enterprising users have gone on to automate just about any task they could think off with these devices. These include cat feeders, home security cameras, web servers, FM radio transmitters, and thousands more. 